



FOR SUCCESS

Your happiness in your own hands

Participant Workbook

May 18 & 19, 1995
Company Retreat

EDUCATIONAL
DISCOVERIES

Welcome to Choices for Success

The purpose of this program is for you to learn how to:

- identify your purpose and vision,
- deeply connect with your personal power,
- discover barriers to your success,
- re-pattern success-limiting thoughts, beliefs and behaviors.

*This workbook
belongs to:*

Paradigm

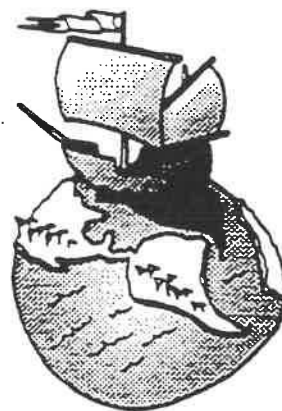
The basic belief and value system that dictates attitudes and behaviors.



Earth is flat.

Paradigm Shift

Drastic, hard-to-grasp change. Radically innovative solutions to old, as well as new, problems. Not the step-by-step, tried-and-true methods of change, but whole new approaches.



Earth is round.

Head
What was
learned in
the past



Heart
What is
happening
now

Our brain (head, mind) is a catalogue of all past experience. It is a valuable reference point. Its purpose is to accumulate information and process it according to what we have already learned. Our heart is what is happening now. It does not judge right or wrong. It tells us what is true about the present moment. Our heart responds from the context we are committed to at the moment. All of us are living according to some purpose. If our purpose changes, so will the answer from our heart. We need a marriage of our hearts and heads to be complete.

What is my role in my family/relationship and/or organization?

The answer from my head:

The answer from my heart:

What do I want from this program?

How will I know if I've accomplished it?

How far am I willing to go to get it?



What is my childhood purpose?

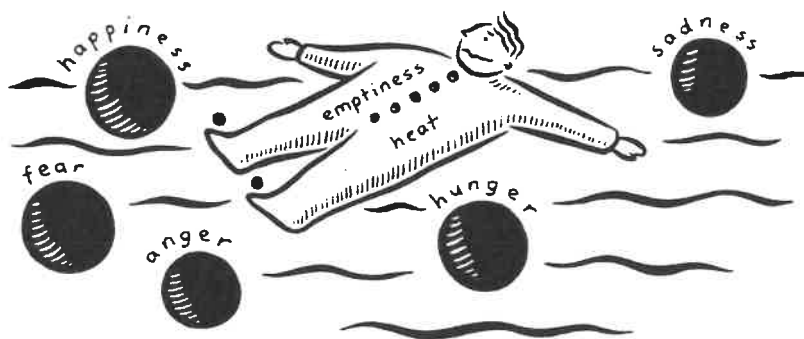
Did I make any decisions about life at my birth?

In the womb there were only sensations and bliss, then we learned to name the sensations. We called them feelings. We put the same value of "good" or "bad" on them that our parents did or we rebelled and made them the exact opposite. Then we made up a story to make the feelings be about someone or something else.

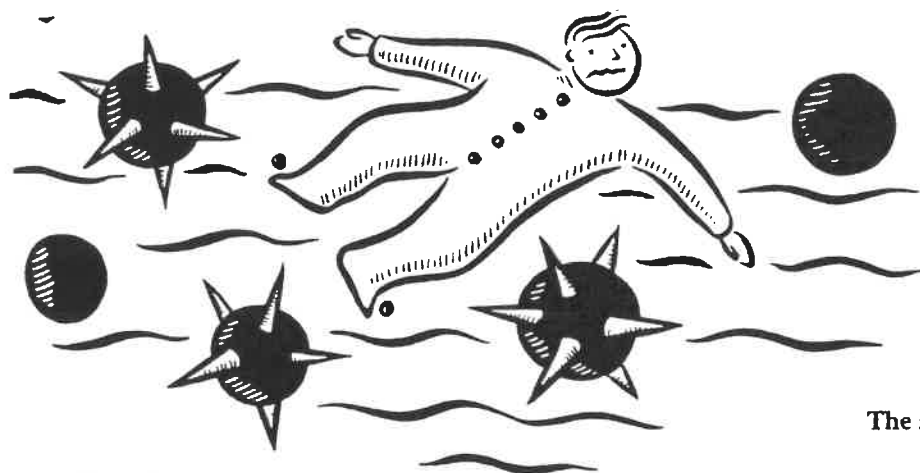


Sea of bliss

Now in the sea of bliss we have our sensations and the way we learned to interpret them — our feelings.

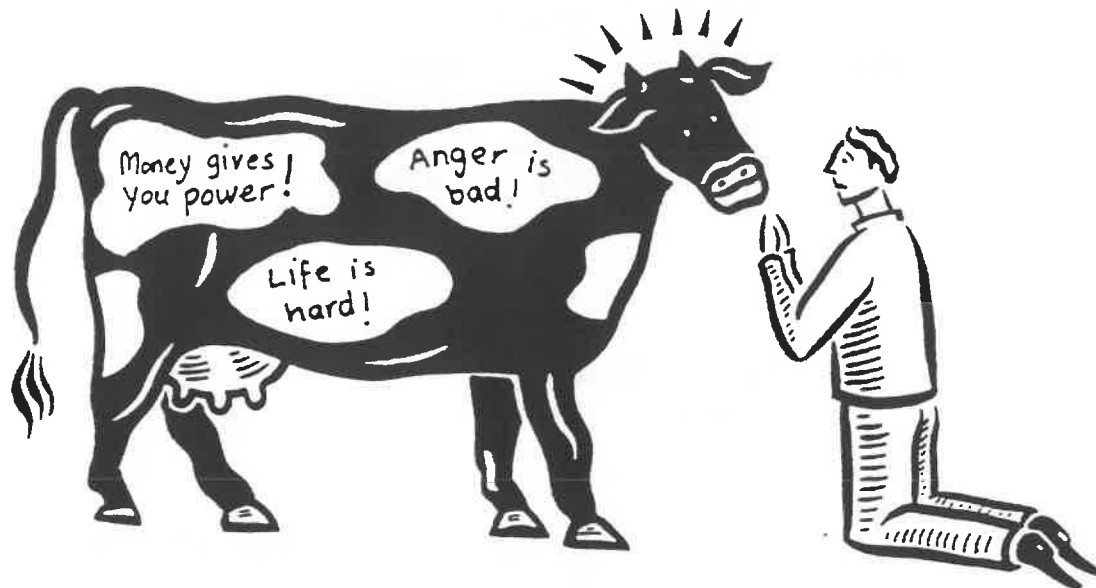


Sea of bliss with sensations and feelings



The sea of bliss gets crowded

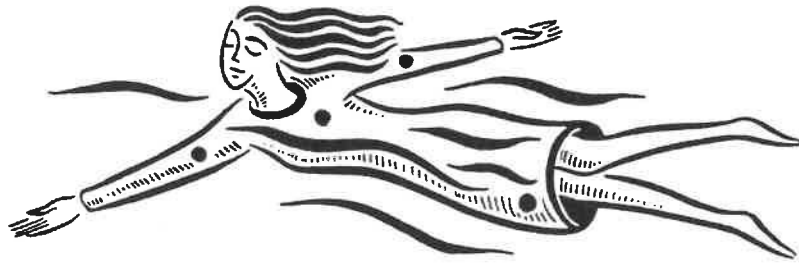
Beliefs become our “sacred cows” of reality. They are an unquestioning acceptance of some picture of reality as being true without positive knowledge or proof. These beliefs are handed down by our family, environment, and culture.



Beliefs

Some of my “sacred cows:”

Feelings are waves

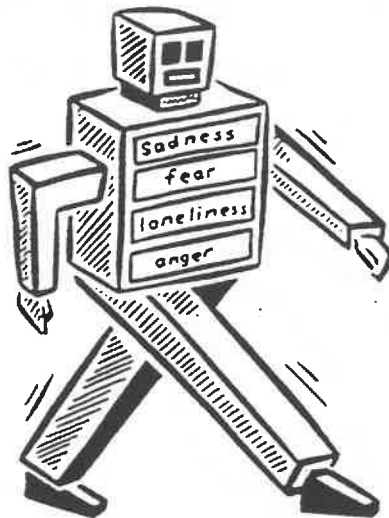


and are all equal

We protected and covered up the feelings that were not okay in our families. Which feelings were okay in my family, school, community, and/or company, and which were not?

Okay	Not Okay

Feelings not experienced



persist and control you

The feelings that
control me:

Feelings that
persist in my life:

Reactions are a cover-up.
They protect our true feelings
and experience.



Big Clues to know when you are in reaction:

- your body feels tight and anxious, not present
- events appear to be coming at you—you feel like a victim, a victimizer, and a judge all at the same time
- you think that what you feel is because of someone else
- your mind won't shut up
- you are judging yourself or someone else
- you feel compelled to act or not act
- you think other people are doing something to you
- your thoughts relate to the past or the future, not the present

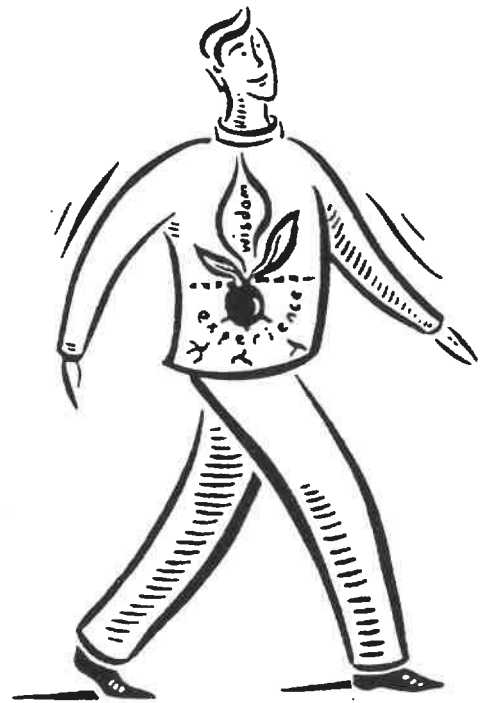
Some of my favorite (consistent, "tried and true," habitual) reactions:

What it was like in my family:



What is the connection?

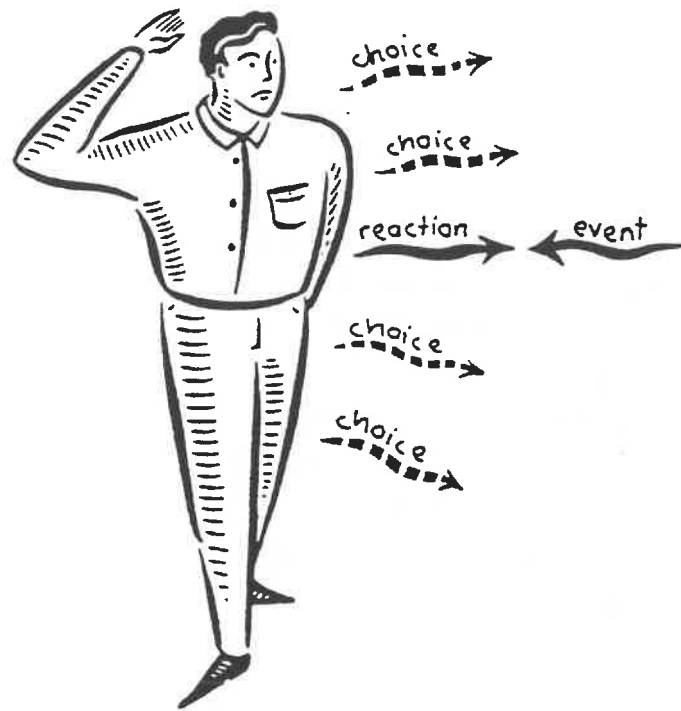
Wisdom is the result of experience



Thoughts are the result of interpretations



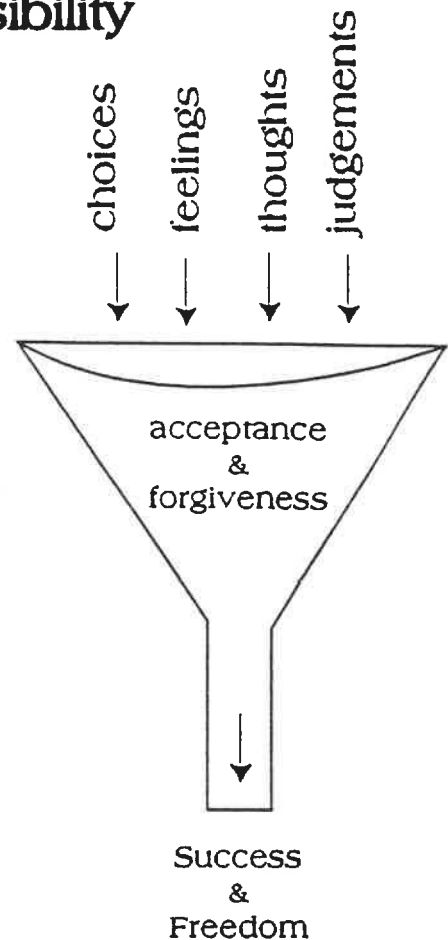
Personal Freedom



Ability to respond in the present
from unlimited options

Personal Responsibility

Personal responsibility means that you are the source of your experience. This does not mean that you chose negative external events to occur in your life or that anyone does. It does mean you have the power to perceive these events, and therefore, choose how you experience them. This leads to the acceptance and forgiveness of all your choices, feelings, thoughts, and judgments, which in turn, leads to success and freedom.



Basic assumptions of personal responsibility: 1) that your parents loved you to the best of their ability 2) that the universe is neutral 3) that people are just doing what they are doing—you just happen to be there.

The reason we don't automatically live a personally responsible life is that we are loyal to our history, to our comfort zone, and to our reactions.

You know you are being responsible when there is:

- no blame,
- no justifying, and
- no hiding.

This creates paradox

Unconditional love

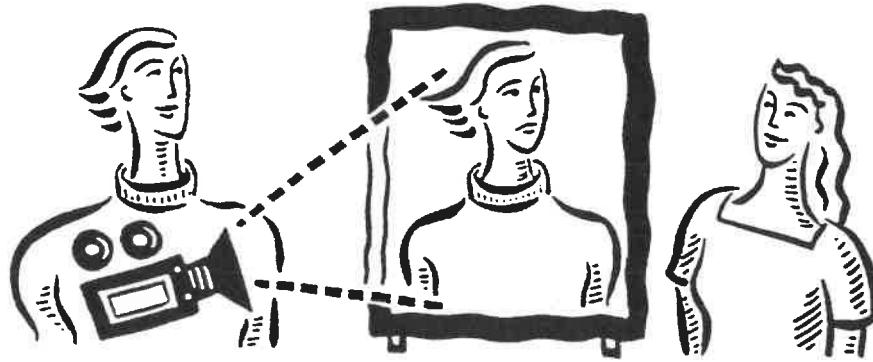


No exclusions

Unconditional love means that you accept all of you. All of your feelings and thoughts, all of your body. It will end judgment and heal the shameful secrets you fearfully keep from the world. It brings clear integrated messages from your heart and mind. If everyone in the world lived from a place of unconditional love, war would end, personal violence would subside, and there would be no more crime.

So what stops us?

Projection



Projection is giving your energy and power away by thinking that you are behaving a certain way because someone else wants you to. Even if they do want you to! Or thinking that someone else is feeling what you, yourself, are feeling. We usually do this because we don't want to see ourselves. Anything that has a value judgment is a projection.

Control = Fear of loss



Ways I control others:

Ways I control myself:

Taking care of = taking away from



and results in loss of power

Whenever you try to take care of someone by controlling their feelings and experiences you are taking away their freedom. You create co-dependency. When you feel uncomfortable and feel a need to protect someone from your truth so that you don't "hurt their feelings" or "incur their wrath," you are sabotaging the relationship. Support, on the other hand, is shown by sharing your truth with the other person with nothing added or withheld. Giving support builds respect. It may not always feel good in the moment, but the end result is worth it.

Intimacy



Intimacy is the highest level of communication skills. True intimacy is telling someone how you feel, or how you think, or what you experience without blaming the other person for it. Talking about you—your experience, your desires. To be able to accomplish that you have to let yourself know what those truths are. You have to look in the mirror and accept what you see. It is very different from talking about your personal life. Intimacy doesn't necessarily give facts about you, it gives the other person an experience of you. To do that, you have to let yourself know who you really are.

Integrity



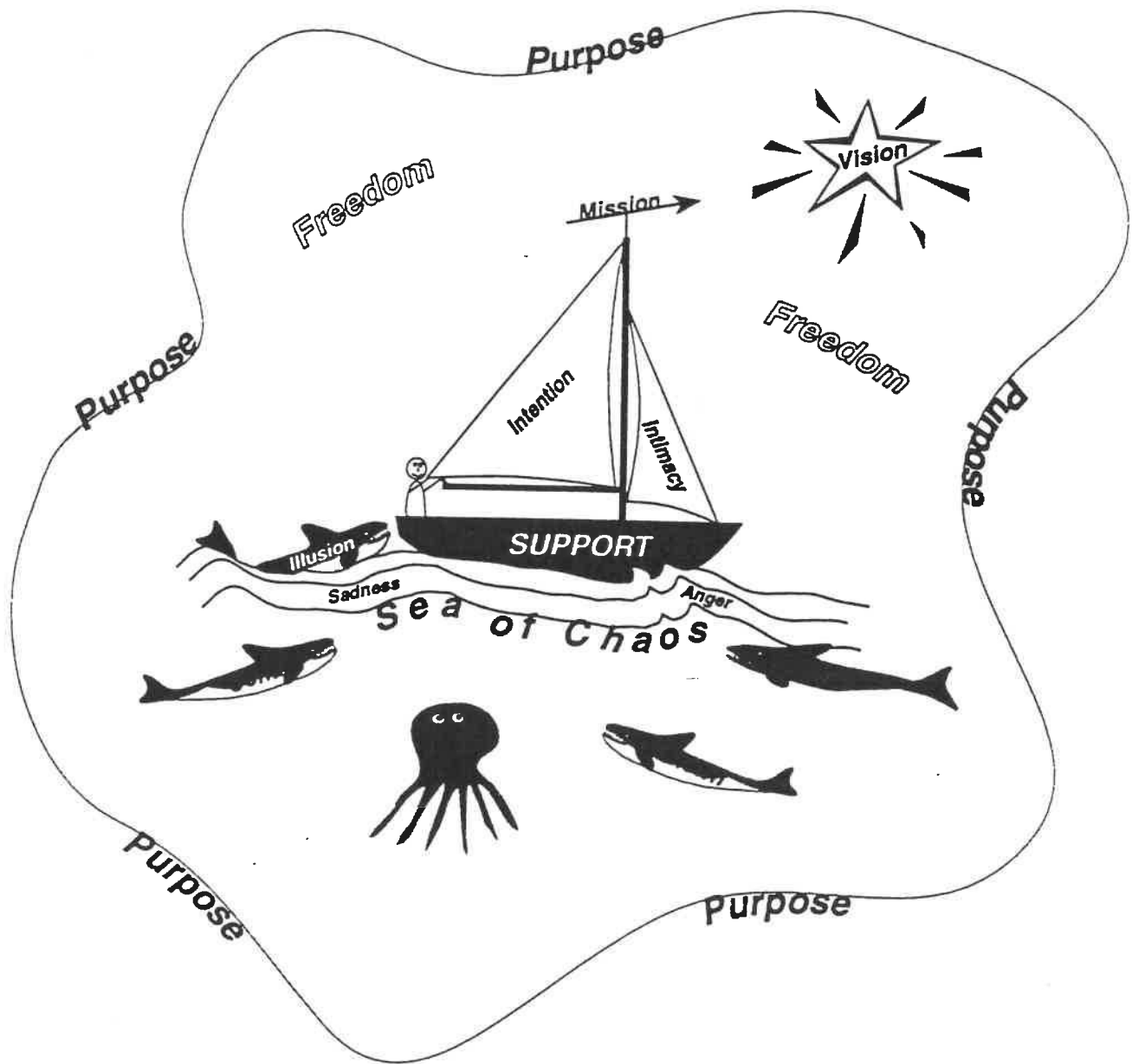
Integrity is you being and living who you really are, not who others want you to be. It means that you live your life according to your true values and beliefs. In order to do that, you need to know what your true values and beliefs are. This means looking inside and giving up approval. It is a life-long process.

True guilt is a message from your soul to stop a particular behavior. It does not mean being afraid of punishment from someone else.



It is a deep feeling inside that something you are doing, thinking, or feeling is not okay with YOU.

Vision is your guide through the Sea of Chaos



When reactions threaten to take us over or when change feels too chaotic, having a vision of who we want to be and how we want to live pulls us through. It gives us something to steer by, something to remind us of our true selves in the midst of turmoil.

Your vision is your guide through the chaos of change. It's your heart's picture of your soul's purpose. A vision is literally a picture of who and what you have committed yourself to be. It pulls you through the roughest times and past the siren call of illusion or comfort. It is a navigational guide that helps you choose the behavior that will get you your heart's desire.

When you decide to make a change, chaos occurs. It is important to have a vision for how you want to live your life to help keep you on course. Without this vision that is bigger than you—that will keep you from doing habitual behaviors that will ease your discomfort—you will feel like a failure.

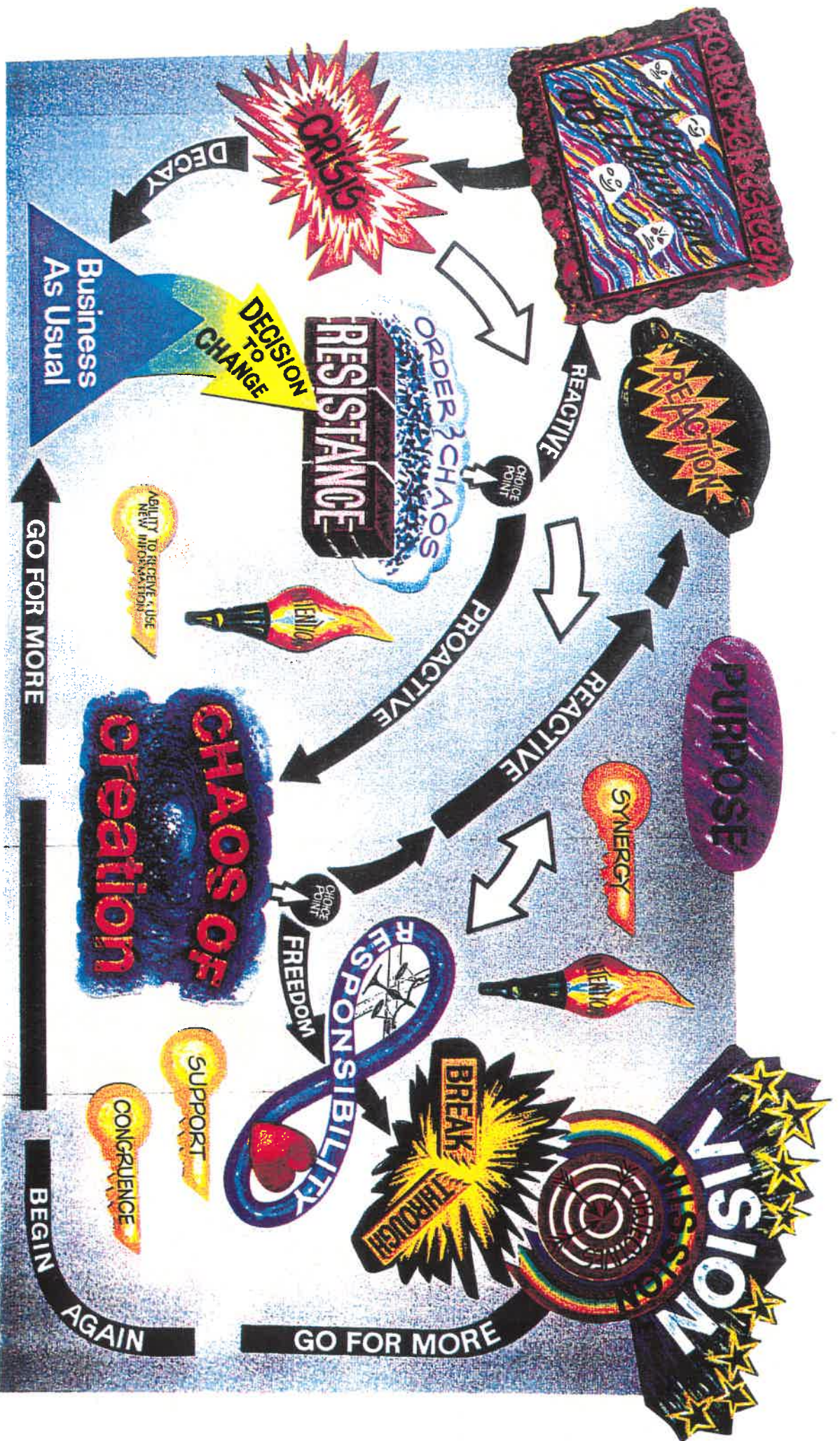
When you abandon your vision, you feel terrible and start to believe your reactions. When you remember your vision and ACT on it, there is fear of loss. And there is a loss of a childhood connection to your family history. When you live your vision you can experience Joy and Self Respect, even when things are not going your way.

my vision:

Ten Steps of The Model for Change

- Step 1.** Whether it is prompted internally or externally, you recognize the need to change, to leave what you are familiar with—the status quo. The decision needs a clear vision, a strong intention and support to carry it through.
- Step 2.** Your inner resistance to the change hits! You desire to go back to what you know. In order for resistance to occur, there must be an equal balance of order and chaos. Order represents the familiar—what was; chaos represents the new—the unknown.
- Step 3.** The interaction of order and chaos causes immense agitation. Order and chaos are neither wrong nor right and both are necessary for the change to occur. Likewise, the agitation is neither good nor bad.
- Step 4.** If the agitation gets strong enough, something has to give. You move to a choice point—you will go one way or the other.
- Step 5.** Choosing the past does not work. If the past was workable there would be no need to change in the first place. Choosing the past results in illusion, a self-deception. You either deceive yourself into thinking that the change was not necessary, or that you have already achieved it. Self-deception eventually erodes your self-esteem.
- Step 6.** When you consistently choose illusion, you often cannot see what you are doing. You create a crisis which can wake you up to the change you need to make. The crisis can be ignored, which eventually leads to demise; or, it can shake you up enough to recommit to the change, and mean it this time.
- Step 7.** The other option is to risk the unknown and do something new—to stay with your intention to change. This choice throws us into the chaos of creation. “Chaos” because you are pulled in opposite directions—you are in paradox, maintaining two seemingly opposite experiences at once. “Creation” because when you are in the unknown, you have the space to choose new behaviors. You need to learn to be able to simultaneously acknowledge the past and create the future by staying with your decision to change.
- Step 8.** Chaos is extremely uncomfortable and leads to another choice point. At this point, strong intention and support are critical! It is easy to lose sight of your vision and fool yourself. You need the support of people who know your intention and vision and who will help you stay on track.
- Step 9.** Staying in chaos is essential to shift to the new paradigm—personal freedom. You are the source of your experience and are able to receive and use new information. You change the way you see. The same data means something different than it did before. You are able to discover new solutions to old problems. You demonstrate the context of personal responsibility.
- Step 10.** You are at a critical point because life doesn't feel, look, or seem familiar. It usually doesn't fit your pictures of how things are. At this point, you need to remember your decision and intention and stay congruent, using everything you have learned so far. It is okay that things don't look and feel as expected. If you continue to risk the unknown, you will have continued breakthroughs and will get closer and more connected to your vision.

THE MODEL FOR CHANGE®



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